SCT_DA_1 Final Report

Superstore Sales Dashboard Analysis

SkillCraft Technology – Task 01

Executive Summary

This project involved cleaning, analyzing, and visualizing the **Sample Superstore Sales Dataset** using **Microsoft Excel** to develop a comprehensive business intelligence dashboard. The final dashboard provides actionable insights into sales, profitability, category performance, regional trends, and sub-category effectiveness through KPI cards, Pivot Tables, Pivot Charts, slicers, and conditional formatting.

The objective was to transform raw transactional sales data into an interactive dashboard capable of supporting strategic decision-making.

Project Objectives

Primary Goals:

- Clean and structure raw sales data
- Analyze Total Sales and Total Profit
- Track Sales Trends Over Time
- Evaluate Profitability by Category and Sub-Category
- Compare Regional Performance
- Highlight high and low performers using Conditional Formatting
- Build an interactive dashboard with slicers for dynamic filtering

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Tools & Technologies Used

- **Microsoft Excel**
- Pivot Tables
- Pivot Charts
- KPI Cards
- Slicers
- Conditional Formatting
- Data Cleaning Techniques

- Dashboard Design Principles

Dataset Overview

Metric	Value
Total Records	9,994
Total Sales	$2,297,201
Total Profit	$286,397
Profit Margin	12.47%
Categories	Furniture, Office Supplies, Technology
Regions	Central, East, South, West

Dashboard Components

1. KPI Performance Cards

Included Metrics:

- Total Sales
- Total Profit
- Total Orders
- Profit Margin

Business Value:

Provides immediate high-level understanding of organizational performance.

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2. Profit by Category Analysis

Findings:

- **Technology** generated the highest profits
- **Office Supplies** delivered stable profitability
- **Furniture** underperformed significantly

Insight:

Technology should remain a major strategic focus, while Furniture pricing and discount strategies require optimization.

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3. Sales Trend Over Time

Key Observations:

- Seasonal spikes in monthly sales
- Revenue fluctuations across order periods
- Useful for forecasting demand and campaign timing

Strategic Value:

Supports inventory planning and promotional scheduling.

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4. Sub-Category Performance

Top Performers:

- Phones
- Storage
- Copiers

Weak Performers:

- Tables
- Bookcases
- Certain furniture segments

Insight:

Sub-category analysis helps identify specific profitability opportunities and operational weaknesses.

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5. Regional Performance

Strongest Region:

- West

Weakest Region:

- Central

Business Recommendation:

Improve logistics, pricing, and market penetration strategies in underperforming regions.

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6. High/Low Performer Dashboard Table

Features:

- Conditional formatting arrows

- Region sales comparison
- Region profit comparison

Value:

Provides rapid visual identification of operational strengths and weaknesses.

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7. Interactive Slicers / Filters

Available Filters:

- Category
- Region
- Segment
- Sub-Category

Advantage:

Allows users to dynamically explore data across multiple dimensions.

Key Business Insights

Major Findings:

- Technology is the highest-value category
- Furniture contributes lower profitability despite sales volume
- West region dominates performance
- Central region requires strategic improvement
- Certain sub-categories generate losses
- Profit margins can be improved through category-level optimization

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Recommendations

Strategic Actions:

1. Increase Technology Investment

Expand profitable product lines and marketing campaigns.

2. Optimize Furniture Strategy

Reduce discount dependency and review supplier costs.

3. Strengthen Central Region Performance

Improve customer targeting, pricing, and logistics.

4. Focus on High-Profit Sub-Categories

Prioritize Phones, Storage, and Office products.

5. Reduce Loss-Making Products

Reevaluate Tables and underperforming inventory.

Dashboard Design Strengths

Positive Aspects:

- Strong executive dashboard structure
- Professional KPI hierarchy
- Excellent dark-themed business design
- Effective use of slicers
- Comprehensive analytical depth
- Good visual storytelling

Suggested Enhancements:

- Display Profit Margin as percentage format
- Improve regional chart clarity
- Add dedicated recommendation summary panel
- Slightly simplify visual glow for cleaner corporate presentation

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Conclusion

The **SCT_DA_1 Superstore Sales Dashboard** successfully demonstrates advanced Excel analytics, dashboard development, and business intelligence capabilities.

This project showcases:

- Data cleaning
- Data visualization
- Analytical thinking
- KPI reporting
- Business intelligence
- Executive dashboard design

It serves as a strong portfolio project for aspiring:

- Data Analysts

- Business Analysts
- Excel Dashboard Developers
- BI Professionals

Final Outcome

Project Status:

Successfully Completed

Deliverables:

- Cleaned Dataset
- Excel Dashboard
- Business Insights Report
- Interactive Filters
- GitHub Portfolio Submission